The Parishioner

Sunday 25-October-2026



Thirtieth Sunday In Ordinary Time

The Pharisees fault was not gratitude for doing good hut contempt for those less successful, a lack of humility before the grace of God. Paul too could 'boast' and give thanks that he had kept the faith, but he recognised that this had not been simply his own doing but because 'the Lord stood by me.' We too should thank God for any good we have been able to do. It is with his help that we do it, and it gives us no grounds for complacency or a sense of superiority.



The Family of Parishes of: Ballincollig | Ballinora | Kilmurry | Ovens and Farran

'Love One Another As I Have Loved You'

The Scripture Readings today challenge us to reflect on our response to God's commandment of love.
In the first Reading we hear of the loving relationship the people of Israel were expected to have towards the under privileged and vulnerable. Widows and orphans; people forced to leave their Countries due to circumstances such as wars, plagues or famines; as well as the poor who had to borrow to survive. The Israelite people had been treated compassionately by a God of love in their times of vulnerability and now were to treat others as they themselves were treated.

In the second reading, St Paul praises the Thessalonians for remaining faithful to the Gospel in spite of obstacles. The life that they lived by the power of the Holy Spirit enabled them to spread their loving faith in God to surrounding places; becoming a model for others by the witness of their lives. We too are called to do the same. May we witness to others the joy of the Gospel both in word and deed.

In the Gospel, the Pharisees put a question to Jesus asking 'which is the greatest commandment of the law'. In response, Jesus says 'You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, and with all your soul, and with all your mind.' This is the greatest and first commandment. And the second is like it: 'You shall love your neighbour as yourself'. To love God with our whole being means having God as the centre of our life. If God is at the centre of our lives then loving our neighbour ought to flow from that. It sounds simple but it is very challenging! I'm sure we all face situations where we find it difficult to love our neighbour as ourselves - our neighbour may be someone we work with, live with - yet Jesus also created that person out of love and Jesus died for that person. The love we know God has for ourselves is also the love God has for the person beside me, for the people I may not particularly like, and the people who may not particularly like me. If we really think about God loving everyone as much as he loves us, we'd see everyone in a new way! Everyone is special to God.

Last weekend was a Phenomenal one for Ballincollig wining below Illustrated Treble of events

Ballincollig RFC J2 Team Won The Muskerry Cup

At the Communities in Bloom International Challenge Showcase Awards in Quebec, Canada, Ballincollig Tidy Towns won the Best International Town in its medium towns category, and we also won the Outstanding Achievement Award for International Plant and Floral Displays.

Ballincollig won the Premier Intermediate Hurling Championship

We congratulate Ballincollig Tidy Towns and its volunteer, the Rugby & GAA Clubs and their players who all played a huge part in achieving this tremendous result



DISCOVERY A faith study as part of the Cork and Ross Diocese faith development

Through Discovery you can deepen your daily life with God and learn a new awareness of just who you are, and how you can live. As the Evangelist John says in 10;10 'have life and have it all in its fullness'. 1 hour per week for 6 weeks. 2 small groups of 6 participants each. Wednesday (Men) Thursdays (Women)

Initial Contact: Fr Alan O'Leary PP or any priest in the family of parishes of Ballinora, Ballincollig, Ovens/Farran & Kilmurry

or

Derval 083 184 74 79 Michael 087 218 52 82

Abide in His Love Women's Conference

Abide Women's Conference, November 20-22, the Great Northern Hotel Bundoran, Co. Donegal. Speakers include: Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Domincans & more, Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, from Cork & Ross Diocese. We would love to welcome you this weekend. For more details please visit Abide in His Love at eventbrite.ie Registration link: https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com

I love you, Lord, my strength.

Ballincollig Parish Number for Priest on Duty is: 087 4021357
For Parish office Telephone is 089 4008181 Mon - Wed. 9.00am - 12.30pm

Visit Our Website: theparishioner.ie or Facebook www.facebook.com/ BallincolligParish

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† IN SYMPATHY †
PLEASE PRAY FOR THE FAMILY AND FRIENDS OF THE RECENTLY DECEASED :
Michéal Devane, Annascaul, Kerry.
Cathy Horgan, Pine Walk.
Brenda Quigley, Glincool.
Siobhán Burke, West Village.

PLEASE PRAY FOR THE REPOSE OF THE SOULS OF THE FOLLOWING WHOSE ANNIVERSARY OCCURS OR OTHERWISE REMEMBERED:
Nicola Callaghan, Maple Lawn.
Finbarr Harrington, Poulavone.
Jerry O'Leary, Knockburden.
Beth Walsh, Sweetbriar Lane.
Statia O'Callaghan, The Old Square & Innishmore.
Una & John Murphy, Blackrock.
Mary Downey, Lough Villas.
Sheila Collins, The Lough.
Larry Williamson, Rosewood Estate.
Finbarr Harrington, Poulavone.
Gerald & Chris Lenihan, Ballyvolane.
Breda O'Donoghue, West Village.
Marie O'Flaherty, Coolroe Meadows.
James O'Sullivan, Kilmichael.
Catherine O'Sullivan, Adrigole.
John & Eugene Cremin, Inniscarra.
Ted O'Regan, Muskerry Estate.
Sheila & Tim Coakley, Castlehaven.
John Coakley, London/Castlehaven.

Formation in Faith for Young Adults

The Diocese of Cork and Ross, in collaboration with UCC Chaplaincy and the Presentation Brothers LEAF Project, is delighted to offer a Formation in Faith programme for young adults (18–35 years). The programme begins on Wednesday, 30 September 2026, and will run for 9 weeks, from 5.45–8.00pm in Mardyke House, Cork (T12 W8RP).
Participants can choose between two concurrent pathways:

a) Sycamore Formation Series: A video-based programme with guided group discussion on Catholic formation.
b) Foundations in Theology: A lecture-based introduction to Catholic theology.
c) Each session begins with food and refreshments, and provide participants with an opportunity to engage in meaningful discussion.

To sign-up or for more information, email Sheila at youthministry@corkandross.org

The Irish Cancer Society

The society is seeking compassionate volunteer drivers to join our pool of drivers. As a volunteer driver you would be bringing patients undergoing chemotherapy to the hospital and back home for their treatment. Gifting your time means that cancer patients will have comfortable (one on one) transport to attend appointments for their lifesaving treatment. If you can spare 2 days per month, have a valid driving licence, and a safe, reliable vehicle, you are the perfect candidate to make a significant difference. The Irish Cancer Society will provide you with training before you start as a driver for us. Your generosity not only eases the journey for many during a challenging time but also offers comfort and support when it's needed most. For more information and to become a volunteer driver, please contact Monica or Emily at volunteer@irishcancer.ie

Mission Sunday Envelope Collection

The envelope collection for the propagation of the faith which was taken up at all churches last weekend 18th/19th October amounted to €1,800. We appreciate your continued generosity.

READINGS FOR THE WEEK

Thirtieth Week In Ordinary Time

25 Sunday Ex 22:20-28. Ps 17. 1 Thess 1:5-10. Mt 22:34-40. Lect I: 717

26 Monday Eph. 4:32-5:8. Ps. 1. Lk. 13:10-17. Lect II: 838

27 Tuesday Eph. 5:21-33. Ps. 127. Lk. 13: 18-21. Lect II: 840

28 Wednesday Eph. 6: 1-9. Ps. 144. Lk. 13:22-30 Lect II: 842

29 Thursday Eph 6:10-20. Ps 143. Lk 13:31-35. Lect II: 844

30 Friday Phil. 1: 1-11. Ps. 110. Lk. 14: 1-6. Lect II: 846

31 Saturday Phil 1:18-26. Ps 41. Lk 14:1-7-11. Lect II: 848

Next Sunday's Readings 01/November/2026
Is 25:6-9. Ps 26. Rom 5:5-11. Mt 11:25-30. Lect I: 1002

Ballincollig Mass Times

St. Mary & St. John		Christ Our Light
8:30 am, 10 am	Sunday	11 am, 12:30 pm
9:30 am	Monday	No Morning Mass
9:30 am	Tuesday	No Morning Mass
9:30 am	Wednesday	8:30 am
9:30 am	Thursday	8:30 am
9:30 am	Friday	8:30 am
6:00 pm (Vigil)	Saturday	7:30 pm (Vigil)

Ballincollig Bulletin Board

Coeliac Hosts

Low gluten hosts are available and suitable for Coeliac's Please inform the priest prior to Mass if possible if you require it.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament

There will be Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament at 3p.m. until 4p.m. in St. Mary & St. John's Church every Friday.

Meditation

Meditation continues in the Ballincollig Community Hall on Tuesday morning after 9.30am Mass. New members welcome.

Cemetery Masses and The Blessing of The Graves

Mass in St. Oliver's Cemetery Sat. November 7th at 2pm.
Mass in St. Mary & St. John's Cemetery Sat. 31st Oct. at 12 noon.

The November Novena for the Holy Souls

Sunday 1st November is All Saints Day. Masses are as per usual Sat./Sun. Mon. 2nd The Feast of All Souls, Tues. 3rd, Wed. 4th, Thurs. 5th, Fri. 6th, Mon. 9th & Tues. 10th November - There will be weekday morning Masses as usual (excluding Monday and Tuesday morning at Christ Our Light): in both churches during the Novena 8.30am in Christ our Light and 9.30am in St. Mary & St. John. There will also be evening Mass at 7.30pm in St. Mary & St John's church each day except Saturday and Sunday.

Special Remembrance Mass

There will be a Special Mass to remember all our loved ones who died during the past year on Friday November 6th at 7.30pm in St Mary & St John. All those whose funerals took place in the Parish will be remembered at this Mass. Families whose relatives' funerals didn't take place in Ballincollig parish and wish to have deceased family members (who died during the past 12 months) included in this Mass are invited to hand in their names to the Sacristy or Parish Office during the week. Please include a contact name and address. Families and individuals are invited to partake